UNION PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

Civil Services (Preliminary Exam) - 2021

CSAT : PAPER-II

(Chapterwise Analysis with Explanation)

Time : 2 hours **Maximum Number : 200**

DECISION MAKINNG ABILITY

Directions for the following 2 (two) items:
Read the following two passages and answer the items that follow. Your answers to these items should be based on the passage only.

Passage – 1

The best universities like Harvard and MIT, despite having the luxury of having some truly excellent teachers on their payroll, are increasingly embracing the "flipped classroom" format, where students listen to video lectures at home, and spend class time applying their knowledge, solving problems, discussing examples, etc. Professors guide that discussion and fill in wherever necessary, explaining those bits that seem to be eluding the students and throwing in advanced ideas that happen to be topical. These universities have made their video lectures available free for anyone in the world. They are also encouraging colleges and universities all over the world to integrate these online courses into their own pedagogy, picking the pieces that are appropriate for their needs and building a package around them.

1. Which one of the following statements best reflects the central idea of the passage given above?

(a) Efficacy of universities would be better in online mode of conducting classroom tuition as compared to conventional method.
(b) Availability of higher education can be made easier and cheaper without diluting the content.
(c) We need not invest much in infrastructure related to higher education and yet develop better human and social capital.
(d) Private sector institutions in higher education as well as coaching institutes can take advantage of this opportunity and thrive well.

Ans. (b) : From all the given statement, the statement (b) reflects the central idea of the given passage, as the availability of quality content worldwide, free of cost. That is what's happening here.
Option (c) is incorrect, nothing has been mentioned about the investment in infrastructure, and option (d) incorrect because 'coaching institute or private sectors not mentioned in the passage, and option (a) is also inappropriate.
Hence, option (b) is correct.

Passage – 2

Our cities are extremely vulnerable to climate change because of large concentrations of populations and poor infrastructure. Moreover, population densities are increasing in them but we have not yet developed the systems to address climate change impacts. Our cities contribute to 65 per cent of the GDP, but there are not enough facilities to cater to the needs of the people. It is important to address the issues of aire quality, transport, etc., that are vital to identifying sustainable solutions. We need to involve citizens in city planning and create an ecosystem that meets the needs of the people.

2. Which among the following is the most logical and rational inference that can be made from the passage given above?

(a) Our cities need to have well-defined administrative set-up with sufficient autonomy.
(b) Ever increasing population densities is a hindrance in our efforts to achieve sustainable development.
(c) To maintain and develop our cities we need to adopt sustainability related interventions.
(d) Public-Private Partnership mode of development is the viable long-term solution for the infrastructure and sustainability problems of India.

Ans. (c) : The most logical and rational interference statement is option (c), it reflects the need for a sustainability related intervention to develop the cities. Option (a) is not discussed in the passage. Option (b) cannot be true as the population is being addressed as a challenge and not a hindrance to achieve sustainable development. Option (d) is incorrect as public private partnership is out of the context.
Hence, option (c) is correct.

Directions for the following 4 (four) items :
Read the following four passage and answer the items that follow. Your answers to these items should be based on the passage only.

Passage – 1

India faces a challenging immediate future in energy and climate policy-making. The problems are multiple. : sputtering fossil fuel production capabilities; limited access to electricity and modern cooking fuel for the poorest; rising fuel imports in an unstable global energy context; continued electricity pricing and governance challenges leading to its costly deficits or surplus supply; and not least, growing environmental contestation around land, water and air. But all is not bleak: growing energy efficiency programmes; integrated urbanisation and transport policy discussion; inroads to enhancing energy access and security; and bold renewable energy initiatives, even if not fully conceptualised, suggest the promise of transformation.

3. Which one of the following statements best reflects the critical message conveyed by the passage given above?

(a) India's energy decision-making process is ever more complex and interconnected.
(b) India's energy and climate policy is heavily tuned to sustainable development goals.
(c) India's energy and climate actions are not compatible with its broader social, economic and environmental goals.
(d) India's energy decision-making process in straightforward supply-oriented and ignores the demand side.

Ans. (a) : According to the passage as it talks about the challenges and prospects of energy and climate policy. The problems are multiple & the mention of myriad factors like sputtering fossil fuel production capabilities, unstable global market, etc. illustrates now the energy decision making process is complex adn interconnected. Hence, option (a) is correct.
Option (b) is incorrect because it does not talk about the variety of functions that are involved in energy adn climate policy maker.

Passage – 2

There are reports that some of the antibiotics-sold in the market are fed to poultry and other livestock as growth promoters. Overusing these substances can create superbugs, pathogens that are resistant to multiple drugs and could be passed along humans. Mindful of that, some farming companies have stopped using the drugs to make chickens gain weight faster. Since Denmark banned antibiotic growth promoters in the 1990s, the major pork exporter says it is producing more pigs — and the animals get fewer diseases.

4. Which one of the following statements best reflects the critical message conveyed by the passage given above?

(a) People should avoid consuming the products of animal forming.
(b) Foods of animal origin should be replaced with foods of plant origin.
(c) Using antibiotics on animals should be banned.
(d) Antibiotics should only be used to treat diseases.

Ans. (d) : In the given passage mentions the ill effects of antibiotics as growth promoters and how some farming companies and alxo, Denmark-a major port exporter banned antibiotic growth promoters bu not its use as a drug to treat diseases.
Hence, option (d) is correct.
Option (a) and (b) are the out of the context. Option (c) ban on total antibiotics is extreme in nature, this does not specify that antibiotics be banned on farming animals alone.

Passage – 3

Policy makers and media have placed the blame for skyrocketing foods prices on a variety of factors, including high fuel prices, bad weather in key food producing countries, and the diversion of land to non-food production. Increased emphasis, however, has been placed on a surge in demand for food from the most populous emerging economies. It seems highly probable that mass consumption in these countries could be well poised to create food crisis.

5. With reference to the above passage, the following assumptions have been made :

1. Oil producing countries are one of the reasons for high food prices.
2. If there is a food crisis in the world in the near future, it will be in the emerging economies.

Which of the above assumptions is/are valid?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (d) : Statement 1 is incorrect because as the passage only mentions that high fuel prices are leading to increasing food prices, it no where explicitly mentioned oil-producing countries being one of the reasons for high fuel prices. And as the passage mentions that food crisis will be caused due to emerging economies, tendency of mass consumption. However, the passage only mentions emerging economies as a causative agent rather than resultant aspect. And it can not be derived the passage that the food crisis will occur in Emerging economies. The given option is more suitable for inference of the passage rather than assumption.
Hence, option (d) is correct.

LOGICAL & ANLYTICAL ABILITY

Directions for the following 3 (three) items :
Read the following two passage and answer the items that follow. Your answers to these items should be based on the passage only.

Passage – 1

Medieval merchants risked the hazards of the Silk Road to reach the markets of China; Portuguese caravels is the 15th century sailed beyond the bounds of the known world, searching less for knowledge than for gold and spices. Historically, the driver for opening frontiers has always been the search for resources. Science and curiosity are weaker drivers. The only way to open up space, whether the space of solar system or interstellar space is to create an economic engine and that engine is resources extraction.

6. Which one of the following statements best sums up the passage given above?

(a) Wealth generation is the primary motive for any human endeavour.
(b) Space, whether space in solar system or interstellar space, will govern our future economy.